

B.T. Franklin

Phoenix, Arizona

Applied AI Technical Lead / Software Architect

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Professional Summary

Applied AI technical lead and software architect with 20+ years building enterprise software, developer tools, and full-stack products. Focused on generative AI, LLMs, agentic systems, multimodal integrations, and AI product architecture.

Core Expertise

Applied AI and LLM Systems; Agentic Workflows and MCP Server Architecture; RAG, Embeddings, and Semantic Matching; AI Product Architecture; Developer Tooling; Full-Stack AI Product Engineering; Technical Leadership.

Professional Experience

Zilliant, Inc.

AI Tech Lead / Staff Software Engineer

April 2025 - July 2026

- Served as organization-wide AI technical leader, guiding engineering teams on adoption of LLMs, agents, evaluation practices, and modern AI development patterns aligned with business goals.
- Served as technical lead and prototype implementer for an agentic offering deployed on AWS and built with the Strands Agents SDK, enabling conversational exploration and explanation of pricing formulas.
- Architected the company's first Model Context Protocol (MCP) server and worked alongside a third-party contractor on its implementation, connecting pricing and formula services to agent workflows that retrieve calculated prices and explain start, target, and floor price reasoning.
- Drove AI tooling adoption across engineering through Codex workflow training, reusable code-review skills, and agent-assisted development patterns that moved PR review and code-production workflows toward faster turnaround.

Software Architect

August 2022 - March 2025

- Designed and implemented a custom generative AI pipeline that enabled real-time integration of diverse pricing insights into customer-facing analytics experiences.
- Led integration of AWS QuickSight and Amazon Q, embedding analytics visualization and generative AI-assisted question answering into the product UI.
- Served as chief architect for a data access API and designed the Zilliant Developer Experience (ZDX) CLI, reducing complex configuration migration work from a multi-day process to a few hours.
- **Earlier Zilliant roles:** Staff Software Engineer (2020-2022) and Senior Software Engineer (2009-2019), leading UI/UX strategy, proof-of-concept and cross-team architecture work, Lightning Web Components adoption, SalesMax development, mentorship, and product modernization.

Founder-Led and Open Source AI Work

- **RepoZest:** Built and deployed a solo GitHub App-backed repository intelligence SaaS for architecture analysis, expertise modeling, hotspots, ownership risk, and AI-generated reports; later sunset and open-sourced.
- **Hiredar:** Built and deployed a solo AI recruiting SaaS in roughly two months using OpenAI extraction, embeddings, Pinecone vector search, RAG-based candidate matching, background workers, Stripe, and recruiter-facing UI.
- **Open source AI tooling:** Created contract4agents, agentic-django, compendiumscribe, promptdown, release-notes-scribe, and reusable AI agent skills.

Research and Publications

Published computational creativity research on AI-driven storytelling and generative music in the *Proceedings of Generative Art Conference* and *Computer Simulation of Musical Creativity Conference*.

Education

Transylvania University, Lexington, KY: BA in Computer Science, 1997; Minor in Psychology; Graduated with Honors.

Skills

Python; JavaScript/TypeScript; OpenAI and Anthropic APIs; Agentic Systems; MCP; RAG; Strands and OpenAI Agents SDKs; Codex; AWS; Django; React; Next.js; Node.js; API and Platform Design; Technical Strategy.